FEDERAL STANDARD STOCK CATALOG

Section IV

(Part 5)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

CLOTH AND TAPE; COTTON, VARNISHED (FOR ELECTRICAL INSULATION)

This specification was approved on the above date by the Director of Procurement, for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government, and shall be put into effect not later than October 1, 1945, for use in procurement initiated on or after that date. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

A. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATION.

A–1. The following Federal Specification, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, shall form a part of this specification:

VV–O–401–Oil; Insulating (for Transformers, Switches, and Circuit-Breakers).

B. TYPES, CLASSES, ETC.

B–1. *Types, classes, and dimensions.*—Varnished cotton cloth and tape for electrical insulation purposes shall be furnished in the types, classes, and dimensions as shown in table I, as specified in the invitation for bids. See paragraph I–1a for service application.

TABLE I. *Types, classes, and dimensions*

Dimensions	Cloth		Tape		
	Type I Yellow Varnish	Type II Black Varnish	Type I Yellow Varnish	Type II Black Varnish	Type II Black Varnish
	Class A, straight cut		Class B, bias cut		Class A, straight cut
Length, per roll	25, 50, or 100 yards		4, 36, or 72 yards		(1)
Thickness	5, 7, 10, or 12 mils		7, 10, or 12 mils		(1)
Width	36 inches, nominal (35 inches minimum), unless special widths narrower than 35 inches are specified in the invitation for bids.		7-mil tape: ½, ¾, 1, or 1¼ inches. 10- or 12-mil tape: ¾, 1, 1¼, or 1½ inches.		(1)

[1] For type II class A tape, all dimensions shall be as specified by the purchaser.

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C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP.

C–1. *Material.*—Material shall be suitable for the purpose intended.

C–2. *Workmanship.*—Workmanship shall be first class.

D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

D–1. See detail requirements.

E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS

E–1. *Dielectric strength.*—When tested as described under paragraphs F–4, F–8 and F–9, cloth and tape shall withstand successfully for 1 minute the voltages shown in table II, using 60-cycle alternating current.

TABLE II. *Dielectric strength*

Item	Volts per mil of thickness			
	After conditioning	After hot oil or petrolatum	After elongation	
			7-mil tape	10- or 12-mil tape
Cloths:				
Type I (yellow)	500	500		
Type II (black)	600	600		
Tapes:				
Type I (yellow)	600	600	300	450
Type II (black)	900	900	400	600

E–2. *Weave.*—The weave of cloth and tape shall be plain weave.

E–3. *Cut.*—

E–3a. Straight cut cloth or tape shall be cut parallel to the warp yarn.

E–3b. Bias cut tape shall be cut so that each yarn forms an angle of not less than 25° with the cut edge of the tape.

E–4. *Number of yarns.*—The minimum yarns per inch of the base cloth used for varnished cloth and tape shall be as shown in table III.

TABLE III. *Yarn count*

Item	Yarns per inch	
	Warp	Filling
Cloth:		
5 mils thickness	68	64
7, 10, or 12 mils thickness	60	55
Tape, all thicknesses:		
Bias cut	64	64
Straight cut	60	55

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E–5. *Thickness Tolerance.*—The minimum and maximum limits for cloth and tape shall be as shown in table IV.

TABLE IV. *Thickness tolerance*

Thickness, mils		
Specified thickness*	Minimum	Maximum
5	4.0	6.0
7	6.0	8.0
10	8.5	11.5
12	10.5	13.5

*For type II class A tape, where thicknesses other than the tabulated values are specified, the tolerance shall be ±15 percent.

E–6. *Width tolerance.*—Regular 36-inch-width cloth shall be furnished with the selvage edge removed, and the trimmed width shall then be not less than 35 inches.

E–6a. For widths specified to be narrower than 35 inches, such special width cloth shall be furnished with the selvage edge removed, and the trimmed width shall then be within ±1/16-inch of the special width specified in the invitation for bids.

E–6b. Tape width tolerance shall be ±1/32 inch. Tape as furnished shall not have a selvage edge.

E–7. *Length tolerance.*—When unrolled, laid flat without tension, and measured with a steel tape, the length of cloth or tape shall be not less than 99 percent of the specified length.

E–7a. When measured by winding the cloth or tape under moderate tension over a drum having a length counter, the length shall be not less than the specified length.

E–8. *Splices.*—Cloth or tape shall not be spliced after varnishing. Prior to varnishing, sewed or cemented splices may be made not to exceed the number per roll shown in table V.

TABLE V. *Splices*

Item	Splices per roll (maximum)
Cloth: All lengths	1
Tape:	
4 yards length	0
36 or 72 yards length	1

E–9. *Continuity.*—Each roll of cloth or tape shall be either one continuous piece or two unjoined pieces, except that the 4-yard rolls of tape shall be furnished only as one continuous piece.

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E–9a. When in two pieces, the rolls shall be flagged with an appropriate marker to indicate the point of interruption. The length of any piece shall be not less than: Cloth, 1 yard; tape, 4 yards.

E–10. *Flexibility.*—The varnish film of cloth or tape shall show no crack visible to the unaided eye when the cloth or tape is bent 180° around a mandrel of ⅛-inch diameter. For cloth, strips of 1 inch width shall be tested; for tape, the width as furnished shall be tested. When tested, the material shall have a temperature of 40 ± 2° F.

E–11. *Additional requirements.*—Requirements for resistance to hot oil or hot petrolatum, breaking strength, tearing strength, and elongation characteristics shall be as specified under paragraphs F–4, F–6, F–7, F–9, and F–10.

F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TESTS

F–1. *Place of inspection and tests.*—Normally, varnished cloth and tape will be inspected and tested by the Government at the place of manufacture and the contractor is required to furnish all necessary facilities at his expense. However, the Government reserves the right to perform inspection and tests elsewhere, at Government expense, such as at a Government laboratory or at point of delivery.

F–2. *Sampling.*—Samples for inspection and tests shall be taken at random from each lot. For the purpose of this specification, a lot shall be considered as consisting of that quantity of varnished cloth or tape of identical type, class, and thickness which is offered for inspection at any one time or which is within a single shipment.

F–2a. *Cloth samples.*—From each lot of varnished cloth, the number of rolls from which samples are taken for inspection and test shall be 10 percent of the lot but not less than 2 rolls.

F–2b. *Tape samples.*—From each lot of varnished tape, the number of rolls from which samples are taken for inspection and test shall be 0.1 percent of the lot but not less than 6 nor more than 20 rolls.

F–2c. When cutting specimens from rolls of cloth or tape, not less than two turns of cloth or six turns of tape (except for tape immersed in oil) shall be removed from the roll before specimens are taken; and it is suggested that specimens be occasionally taken from deep within the roll. The quantity of cloth required for tests is approximately 1 square yard; the quantity of tape is approximately 5 lineal yards.

F–3. *Inspection.*—Each lot shall be given a general inspection for packaging, marking, and flagging. Each roll taken by sampling shall be inspected for workmanship, weave, cut, yarn count, thickness, width, splices, continuity, and flexibility.

F–3a. Thickness shall be measured by use of a machinist's type micrometer without locking device; the micrometer vernier shall read to 0.0001 inch, and the anvil and spindle contact faces shall have a diameter of 0.250 ± 0.001 inch. When closing the faces upon the material, the closing action shall be stopped at the point where pressure of the faces develops the initial frictional resistance to the movement of the specimen between the faces. Readings shall be taken at this pressure, and when moving the micrometer from one measurement location to another, the micrometer shall not be opened in excess of 5 mils plus the specimen thickness. Readings shall be taken at 10 locations and the values averaged. The locations shall be spaced

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at approximately equal intervals along the length for tape and across the width for cloth; the peripheries of the contact faces shall be not closer than 0.25 inch from any edge of the specimen, except that for ½-inch and ¾-inch tapes the locations shall be along the longitudinal center. When convenient, and locations are suitable, the thickness measurements taken for the dielectric test (paragraph F–8) may be included among the 10 readings required.

F–4. *Hot oil or hot petrolatum test.*—Specimens of cloth or tape shall show no signs of blistering, wrinkling, or flaking when subjected to the following immersion in hot oil or hot petrolatum:

F–4a. Specimens shall be approximately 12 inches long by 1.5 inches wide, except that specimens of tapes of less than 1.5 inches width shall be in the width furnished.

F–4b. Type I. Yellow varnished cloth or tape shall be submerged for 15 minutes in transformer oil having a temperature maintained at 100 ± 3° C. The specimen shall then be removed. The oil used for the test shall be a paraffin-base oil and shall conform to Federal Specification VV–O–401, Oil; Insulating.

F–4c. Type II. Black varnish cloth or tape shall be submerged for 15 minutes in petrolatum having a temperature maintained at 150 ± 3° C. The specimen shall then be removed.

F–4d. Upon removal of either type, the specimen shall be pressed between blotting or towel paper to absorb excess oil on the surface of the specimen. Flaking shall not be evident on the specimen, on the paper, or in the oil or petrolatum. The specimen shall then be subjected to the dielectric test, paragraph F–8, without conditioning.

F–5. *Conditioning.*—Samples or specimens shall be conditioned for 96 hours at 77 ± 3° F., with 50 ± 2 percent relative humidity immediately prior to performing the following tests: Breaking strength, tearing strength, dielectric strength, elongation-dielectric, and elongation-workability.

F–6. *Breaking strength test.*—When tested as described below, varnished cloth or tape of any thickness shall have an average breaking strength not less than the values shown in table VI. The minimum strength of any individual specimen shall be not less than 85 percent of the value specified as average.

TABLE VI. *Breaking strength*

Item	Pounds, average per inch of width		
	Warp	Filling	Bias [1]
Cloth; straight cut:			
6 mils or less	32	20	----------
Over 6 mils	38	20	----------
Tape:			
Bias cut; all thicknesses	----------	----------	35
Straight cut:			
8 mils or less	32	----------	----------
Over 8 mils	38	----------	----------

[1] With testing force applied in a direction parallel with the length of the tape.

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F–6a. Cloth specimens shall be 1 inch wide, tape specimens shall be the width of the tape; their length shall be as shown under paragraph F–6c. The specimens shall be conditioned in accordance with paragraph F–5, prior to test.

F–6b. A suitable tensile testing machine shall be used. The scale shall be graduated not to exceed 0.5 pound per division.

F–6c. The means for holding the specimen in the testing machine shall be such as to avoid breakage or slippage of the specimen at the holding point. A suggested form for holding the specimen (particularly for bias cut tape) is as follows: Two spools, a spool for each end of the specimen, shall be used for holding the specimen during test; each spool shall be 1 inch diameter. Each end of the specimen shall be wound firmly around its spool for three turns and secured with a suitable adhesive tape so as to avoid slippage. The spools shall be rigidly attached to the testing machine. The length of specimens between the spools shall be approximately six times the specimen's width; to accomplish this spacing, the total length of the specimen should be as follows depending on its width:

Width of specimen	*Length of specimen*
½ inch.	21½ inches.
¾ inch.	23 inches.
1 inch.	24½ inches.
1¼ inches.	26 inches
1½ inches.	27½ inches.

F–6d. The machine shall be adjusted to eliminate slack of the specimen between the spools. Force shall be applied with head travel maintained constant at a rate of 12 ± 1 inch per minute.

F–7. *Tearing strength test, cloth.*—Varnished cloth shall have an average tearing strength of not less than 150 grams for 5 mils thickness and not less than 200 grams for thicker cloth, when tested so that the warp threads are ruptured, as follows:

F–7a. The test specimens shall be 2.5 by 4 inches. Enough specimens shall be used so that at least five readings can be obtained for each sample. The specimens shall be conditioned as prescribed under paragraph F–5, prior to test.

F–7b. The testing machine shall be of the pendulum-impulse type, so designed as to produce a tear approximately 1.66 inches in length. The knife mounted on the machine to cut the slit for the tear shall be maintained sharp.

F–7c. Only one specimen shall be tested at a time. The specimen shall be so arranged that an equal number of tears originating from opposite edges of the specimens will be produced. When a tear deviates more than ¼ inch from a straight line, that tear shall not be considered in the test results.

F–8. *Dielectric strength tests.*—To check for conformance to the requirements of paragraph E–1, tests shall be performed as follows:

F–8a. Cloth specimens shall be 6 inches wide, cut from the roll diagonally at approximately a 45° angle. Tape specimens shall be approximately 36 inches long by the width of the tape. Prior to test, the specimens shall be conditioned in accordance with paragraph F–5.

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F–8b. The test equipment shall have a capacity of not less than 2 kva. The specified test potential shall be applied in full strength and maintained for 1 minute. In applying potential, start at zero volts and reach 70 percent of the test value not sooner than 1 second, and reach 100 percent within 3 seconds.

F–8c. Electrodes for testing cloth shall be brass cylinders measuring 2 inches diameter by 1 inch long, with the edges of the testing faces rounded to ¼ inch radius. Electrodes for testing tape shall be brass rods of ¼ inch diameter with edges rounded to 1/32 inch radius; the upper electrode shall weigh 0.10±.005 pound. The electrode faces shall be flat and smooth. Where guard washers are used, the washers shall be coated with a thin film of petrolatum, care being taken to get none of the petrolatum on the specimen or on the electrode faces.

F–8d. Five tests shall be made along the length of each specimen at approximately equal intervals. Four of the five locations tested shall withstand the specified value for 1 minute; the remaining location shall withstand the specified value for at least 10 seconds.

F–9. *Elongation-dielectric test, for bias tapes.*—Bias cut tapes shall show a dielectric strength not less than the values specified under paragraph E–1, when tested as follows:

F–9a. Specimens shall be at least 30 inches long by the width of the tape, but tapes wider than 1.5 inches shall be trimmed to 1.5 inches width. Prior to test, the specimens shall be conditioned in accordance with paragraph F–5.

F–9b. Each end of the specimen shall be tightly gripped in the jaws of a clamp so that the length of tape between clamps is 70 cm.; the jaws shall be smooth and at least 2 inches wide. The clamps shall in turn be firmly secured in a suitable apparatus for elongating the tape; this apparatus may be a hand-operated or motor-operated pulling outfit, or may be a tensile-testing machine of suitable range.

F–9c. A gage length of 50 cm. shall be marked on the tape, centered between the jaws. The tape shall be elongated to 53 cm. gage length, at a uniform rate of approximately 1 millimeter per second; care must be taken not to stretch the tape beyond 53 cm. because stretching beyond this limit and then relaxing the tape to the proper distance may change its dielectric strength. It shall be maintained in the stretched condition for 5 minutes and then while still stretched shall be promptly tested for dielectric strength. There shall be no relaxation. The dielectric strength shall be tested in the manner described under paragraph F–8.

F–9d. To maintain the specified elongation during the dielectric tests, the tape may be retained in the stretching apparatus, or a rigid frame may be fastened to the stretched tape which frame will maintain the tension so that the tape can be removed from the stretching apparatus. It is important that there shall be no relaxation of tension. Also, thickness measurements made for calculating volts per mil shall be taken while the tape is under tension.

F–10. *Elongation-workability test, for bias tapes.*—Bias cut tapes shall show an elongation of not less than 2.2 percent when tested as follows:

F–10a. Test specimens shall be 36 inches long by the width of the tape, but tapes wider than 1.5 inches shall be trimmed to 1.5 inches

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width. Prior to test, the specimens shall be conditioned in accordance with paragraph F–5.

F–10b. The specimen shall be vertically suspended between clamps, one clamp being attached to a fixed support and the other clamp having a weight attached to or suspended from it. The jaws of the clamp shall be at least 2 inches wide.

F–10c. A gage length of 50 cm. shall be located along the tape so as to be not closer than 10 cm. to either clamp.

F–10d. The weight shall be applied for 35 minutes, and the specified weight shall include the weight of the clamp. The amount of the weight shall be 5 pounds per inch of width for tape of 7 mils or less thickness, and 6 pounds per inch of width for tape exceeding 7 mils thickness.

G. PACKAGING, AND PACKING FOR SHIPMENT.

G–1. *Packaging.*—

G–1a. *Cloth.*—Each roll of cloth shall be wound on a hollow core which is flush with the ends of the rolls; the core shall have an inside diameter of 1½ inches and be sufficiently sturdy to support the cloth without collapsing. Moisture-proof paper shall be wrapped around the roll; the paper shall be either cut flush with or folded over the ends of the roll. The ends of the roll shall be dipped in paraffin.

G–1b. *Tape, 4-yard rolls.*—Shall be wound without cores and packed in multiple in a metal container having a double friction closure. Within the container, the rolls shall be immersed in a high-grade insulating oil having a viscosity between 300 and 4000 seconds at 100° F. (Saybolt Universal). The container shall be plated, treated, or painted to be corrosion-resistant.

G–1c. *Tape, 36 and 72-yard rolls.*—Each roll shall be wound on a hollow core which is flush with the ends of the rolls; the core shall have an inside diameter of 1½ inches and be sufficiently sturdy to support the tape without collapsing. Each roll shall be dipped in paraffin. A quantity of rolls shall be stacked in a column and wrapped in strong paper to form a package not exceeding 15 inches long.

G–2. *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

G–3. *Marking.*—

G–3a. *Unit package.*—Each package or carton shall be plainly marked with the type, class, color of varnish, number and length of rolls, thickness, width, and manufacturer's name.

G–3b. *Containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the material, the type, class, color of varnish, kind of cut, thickness, width, and the number and length of rolls contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H–1. The following departmental specifications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, shall

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form a part of this specification and shall be applicable to purchases made under this specification by the respective departments:

H–2. *Army.*—United States Army Specification No. 100–2, Standard Specification for Marking Shipments by contractors, copies of which may be obtained without cost upon application to the Quartermaster Corps, War Department, Washington 25, D. C.

H–3. *Navy.*—

H–3a. *Navy Department specifications.*—

General Specifications for Inspection of Material:

39P16—General Specifications for Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment:

Section V—Boxes, wood, cleated, plywood.
Section VI—Boxes, wood, nailed.
Section VII—Boxes, wood, wire-bound.
Section XXV—Barrier material, waterproof, flexible.

Copies of the above-referred-to specifications may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington 25, D. C., except that Naval activities should make application to the Supply Officer in Command, Naval Supply Depot, Bayonne, N. J.

Copies of the Navy Shipment Marking Handbook may be obtained by naval activities and others upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts.

H–3b. *Packaging.*—Unless otherwise specified, varnished cotton shall be packaged as follows:

H–3b (1). Rolls of class A cotton cloth shall be wrapped individually with 60-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper and sealed with not less than 2-inch width, 60-pound minimum basis weight kraft gummed tape.

H–3b (2). Rolls of class B cotton tape shall be packaged individually in substantial folding cartons or set-up boxes.

H–3b (3). Rolls of class A cotton tape ½-inch width, up to and including 3-inch width, shall be packaged as described in paragraph H–3b (2); tapes over 3-inch width shall be packaged as described in paragraph H–3b (1).

H–3c. *Packing.*—

H–3c (1.) *For domestic shipment.*—Unless otherwise specified, varnished cotton packaged as described in paragraph H–3b shall be packed in cleated plywood boxes, nailed wood boxes or wirebound boxes conforming to the requirements of Navy Department Specification 39P16, Sections V, VI, and VII, respectively, or in suitable style corrugated or solid fiberboard boxes conforming to the following requirements:

Maximum gross weight	Minimum average bursting strength	Maximum sum of inside dimensions
Pounds	*Pounds*	*Inches*
40	200	60
65	275	75

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Bottom flaps of fiberboard boxes shall be sealed by means of a suitable adhesive or metal-stitched. Top flaps shall be sealed, stitched, or taped, or closed by a combination of these methods. If taped, kraft gummed tape of not less than 2½-inch width, 60-pound minimum basis weight or equal shall be used. No strapping will be required. In cleated plywood boxes, no water-resistant or toxic-treated plywood will be required. The gross weight of boxes of wood construction shall not exceed approximately 150 pounds.

H–3c (2). *For overseas shipment.*—Unless otherwise specified, varnished cotton packaged as described in paragraph H–3b, shall be packed in cleated plywood boxes, nailed wood boxes, or wirebound boxes, conforming to the requirements of Navy Department Specification 39P16, Sections V, VI, and VII, respectively. Shipping containers shall be lined with a sealed waterproof bag, or its equivalent, made from material conforming to the requirements of Navy Department Specification 39P16, Section XXV, for case liners. The seams and closures shall have strength and water-resistance equal to that of the body material. In lieu of case liners, individual rolls of cotton shall be enclosed in a sealed waterproof bag, or equivalent conforming to the above requirements. Shipping containers shall be strapped in conformance with the requirements of the appendix of the applicable box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed approximately 150 pounds.

H–3c (3). *For domestic or overseas shipment.*—Where practicable, shipping containers of similar construction shall be of uniform size, and shall contain the same number of items of one size, thickness, and type. Containers shall be designed to fit the contents in a compact manner.

H–3d. *Marking.*—

H–3d (1). *Packages.*—Unless otherwise specified, each package shall be plainly marked with the following information completed:

ARTICLE _____
STOCK NO. _____
SIZE _____
TYPE _____
THICKNESS _____
QUANTITY _____
CONTRACTOR _____
MANUFACTURER _____

H–3d (2). *Shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, each shipping container shall be plainly marked in black with the following information completed:

ARTICLE _____
STOCK NO. _____
SIZE _____
TYPE _____
THICKNESS _____
QUANTITY _____
CONTRACTOR _____
MANUFACTURER _____

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CONTRACT NO. ----------
GROSS WEIGHT ----------
CUBE ----------

In addition to the foregoing, marking shall conform to the requirements of the latest issue of the Navy Shipment Marking Handbook.

I. NOTES

I–1. Purchasers should specify type, class, length, thickness, and width, see paragraph B–1.

I–1a. *Service application.*—Varnished cotton cloth or tape for electrical insulation is used principally as a wrap for motor windings, transformer windings, coil windings, cable insulation, and cable splicing. The yellow varnished type is normally used when the material will be in continual or frequent contact with transformer oil; the black varnished type is normally used when the material will not be in contact with oil except for occasional brief contact. The straight cut tape (type II class A tape) is not normally used except in the manufacture of cable; it is included in this specification primarily for purposes of reference in connection with the purchase of cable.

I–2. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

I–3. Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

I–4. An Index of Federal Specifications and also a Quarterly Supplement-Index of Emergency Alternate Federal Specifications may be purchased as noted in the paragraph below, prices to be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

I–5. Copies of this specification, and VV–O–401, may be obtained upon application, accompanied by postal note (or money order), or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. Price 5 cents. Price of VV–O–401, 5 cents.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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